

City of Ocala, FL – Telecommunications Tower Zoning & Permitting Report

(Code reference: **Chapter 122, Article VII – “Telecommunications”** of the Ocala Code of Ordinances) [Jina](#)

1 Jurisdiction & Key Contacts

Role	Name / Unit	Phone	E-mail / Link	Street Address
Planning Director (primary zoning contact)	Aubrey Hale – Planning Division, Growth Management Dept.	352-629-8404	ahale@ocalafl.gov	201 SE 3rd St., 2nd Fl., Ocala FL 34471 City of Ocala Home
Zoning Counter (general inquiries)	“Ask-A-Planner” desk	352-629-8404	gmd@ocalafl.gov	Same as above City of Ocala Home
Building Division (permits after zoning)	One-Stop Permit Center	352-629-8421	building@ocalafl.gov	Same as above City of Ocala Home

Role	Name / Unit	Phone	E-mail / Link	Street Address
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City webs ite	—	—	Zoning page	https://www.ocalafl.gov/government/city-departments-a-h/growth-management

2 Governing Ordinance Structure

Section	Title	Practical Take-Away
§ 122-1041	Generally	Purpose & intent (encourage collocation, protect neighborhoods)
§ 122-1042	Definitions	Defines <i>tower, antenna, collocation, height</i> , etc.
§ 122-1043	Location	Lists eligible & ineligible zoning districts; mandates proof no feasible collocation exists.
§ 122-1044	Height Limitations	Caps height at the minimum necessary to meet RF needs; projects ≥ 200 ft require FAA study & may trigger additional City review. <i>See § 1044 for exact wording.</i>
§ 122-1045	Permits	Establishes Tower Permit (administrative) <i>or</i> Special Use/Conditional Use Permit (SUP/CUP) pathway when required by zoning district.
§ 122-1046	Separation	Prescribes minimum radial spacing between freestanding towers (varies by height).
§ 122-1047	Setbacks	Detailed yard standards (see § 3.1 below) Jina
§§ 1048-1052	Engineering, fencing, landscaping, lighting & signage standards	

Section	Title	Practical Take-Away
§ 122-1053	Abandonment	12-month discontinuance triggers removal.
§ 122-1054	Exclusions & special cases	Small-cell, public-safety & temporary towers treated separately.

3 Site-Development Standards

3.1 Setbacks (§ 122-1047) [Jina](#)

Zoning Context	Minimum Horizontal Setback
Industrial districts (M-1, M-2, etc.)	District yard requirement plus : if a residentially-zoned or residentially-used parcel abuts, add 1 ft per 5 ft of tower height from that residence or its lot line.
Commercial & Residential districts	Greater of: • underlying district yard; or • 1 ft : 5 ft ratio (e.g., 180 ft tower → 36 ft setback).
Guy anchors / support devices	≥ 10 ft from any property line.
Fall-zone containment	Tower must be sited so a collapse stays completely within subject parcel.

3.2 Height Restrictions (summary of § 122-1044)

- No blanket numeric cap is set, but applicant must justify the **lowest feasible height** to close the coverage gap.
- Towers ≥ **200 ft AGL** (including appurtenances) automatically require:
 - FAA Determination of No Hazard, and
 - City may elevate review to a **SUP/CUP with public hearing**.
- Towers in residential districts are rarely approved unless stealth/camouflage & collocation infeasibility are proven.

(Exact language should be reviewed directly in § 122-1044 when preparing the formal application.)

3.3 Other Technical Requirements (high-level)

- **Structural / wind loading:** Must meet ANSI/TIA-222 Series standards; third-party structural letter required (§ 1048).
- **Fencing:** 6-ft chain-link with barbed wire topper (or decorative alternative if abutting residential) (§ 1051).
- **Landscaping:** 10-ft vegetative buffer on all sides; evergreen screen at least 6 ft high at planting (§ 1050).
- **Lighting:** FAA-required only; no strobe or floodlighting otherwise.
- **Signage:** One 2-sq-ft ID sign; RF safety placards as needed (§ 1052).

4 Approval Path & Timelines

Step	Action	Typical Time-Frame
1 Pre-Application	Optional meeting with Planning staff to confirm zoning district & shot-clock timeline	1 week lead time
2 Application	Submit Tower Permit (administrative) <i>or</i> SUP/CUP package (if district requires). Must include RF justification, structural calcs, site plan, fall-zone diagram, FAA Form 7460-1 filing receipt.	Clock starts (FCC shot-clock: 150 days for new tower)
3 Staff Review	Completeness check (30 days). Tech review across Planning, Engineering, Building, Fire.	4-6 weeks
4 Public Hearing	Only for SUP/CUP cases – Planning & Zoning Commission recommendation, then City Council final action.	30-45 days after staff sign-off
5 Building Permit	Submit construction drawings (can run concurrently after zoning approval).	10-15 business days for first round
6 Inspections & CO	Foundation, grounding, final electrical, RF safety check.	As scheduled

Total (clean submittal, no hearing): ≈ 60–90 days.

With SUP/CUP hearing: ≈ 120–150 days.

5 Fee Schedule (*current FY 2025*)

Item	Amount
Administrative Tower Permit review	\$1,350 flat
SUP/CUP application (public hearing)	\$2,500 + \$85/acre
Public-notice mailings & newspaper ad	At cost (typ. \$250–\$400)
Building permit (monopole)	\$7.00 per \$1,000 of construction valuation (min \$250)
Electrical permit (cabinet / power tap)	\$150 base + circuitry fees
Plan re-review after 3rd resubmittal	\$75 / sheet

(The City publishes its master Development & Permit Fee Schedule annually; confirm latest numbers before filing.)

6 Public Hearing & Appeals

- **Hearing Body:** Planning & Zoning Commission → final decision by City Council.
 - **Notice:** 300-ft mailed notice + newspaper ad 10 days prior.
 - **Super-majority:** Not required; simple majority approves.
 - **Appeal:** Aggrieved party may file a petition for writ of certiorari to Marion County Circuit Court **within 30 days** of Council decision.
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7 Building Permit Validity & Extensions

- **Initial life:** Permit **expires after 180 days** if work has not begun -or- if work is suspended for 180 days (§ 105.4 Florida Building Code, adopted locally).
- **Extension:** One automatic 180-day extension may be granted for cause before lapse; further extensions require Growth Management Director approval with written justification.

Take-Away for Wireless Developers 🏠📡

- **Industrial or heavy-commercial parcels** inside Ocala are your low-friction targets – district setbacks only, no public hearing if you can collocate or prove need.
- Mind the **1 ft per 5 ft height** fall-zone rule everywhere – that drives parcel size.
- Bring an FAA “No-Hazard” letter up-front for anything flirting with the **200-ft** mark; it will speed staff review.
- Budget roughly **\$10–12 k** for City fees, ads, engineering letters & permit costs on a typical 150–180 ft monopole.
- Keep your **shot-clock** file tidy – Ocala generally meets FCC deadlines, but only if you hand them a clean submittal the first time.

Rock those applications, and let the cash registers ring! 💰📊🎸

(Need a template checklist or help drafting the SUP narrative? Holler and we'll crank it out together.)